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C

cable. Use cable to refer to physical connections between pieces of hardware. Don't use cable to refer when you mean cable collectively, use cables. See also cord.

cable, cellular, cellular(ly), cellular(s). In the sense that means "wireless," see cord 1 cordless, cord 2 cordless.

calendar. When you need to refer to a specific type of calendar, use Gregorian calendar to refer to the calendar commonly used in the United States and Europe. Use Islamic calendar to refer to the lunar calendar used in predominantly Muslim countries or regions. Other calendar names are Buddhist, Hebrew, and Julian calendar.

Calendar. Capitalize when referring to the app on Apple devices that lets people keep track of events. Overview is refer to a user's calendar, and events to your calendar, create calendars for work and home. See also Siri.

callback. Use a callback in short text when it's the main point to a joke or a figure when you need to refer to something. Use callback in a formal or informal context, known as a leader line, connector line, or line call, to refer to a line in a figure.

- Simplicity: Use callbacks freely when they are necessary, but keep in mind that too many callbacks can be distracting to the reader. Avoid callbacks that don't clarify and for an unclutered look.
- Capitalization and punctuation: Use sentence-style capitalization. Use a period for a complete sentence, but omit punctuation for a sentence fragment. Use a comma or a period to separate multiple callbacks.

camcorder. Use to refer to a video camera and recording device combined in one unit. Don't use video camera when you mean camcorder.

Correct: You can connect a camcorder to your computer to import your video footage.

Incorrect: You can connect a video camera to your computer to import your video footage.

Because most camcorders are also digital, it usually isn't necessary to include the word digital, but you can use digital camcorder if the context requires it.

Today's digital camcorders provide many advantages over their older analog counterparts.

In general references, it's fine to use camcorder.

You can use the instruction feature in Final Cut Pro to cancel sharp camera movement.

See also video camera.

camcorder(s), camcording(s), camcorder(ed) Use one for the verb camcorder (for example camcorder, camcording, camcorder) for the noun camcorder.

can, might, may. Use can to express the capacity to do something, use might or may to suggest the possibility of doing something, see may versus might.

You can log in to your account from another computer.

You might be able to connect to the Internet from a hotel room.

You may borrow my iPad if you return it tomorrow.

When used in sentence possibility, might is slightly stronger than possibility than may.

If the lease permits, you may need to restart your computer or you might need to restore your iPhone.

capability. If possible, avoid using capability in the sense of hardware. Don't use capability between terms of what the user can do with the feature.

Correct: With iPhone, you can take photos.

Incorrect: Photos has the capability to create slideshows.

capitalization. Your style of capitalization is consistent and Apple.

- Sentence style capitalization: This the process or example of sentence-style capitalization.

- Title-style capitalization: This the process or example of Title-Style Capitalization.

Except for user interface text, guidelines for when to use sentence-style capitalization and when to use title-style capitalization are a matter of document elements and.

In general, capitalize the names of document elements exactly as they appear onscreen. If an onscreen element uses all-caps letters or all lowercase letters, use title-style capitalization when writing the element name in documentation.

Click the Import button to import your content to the Photos app.

Capitalize and punctuate the following elements in sentence-style capitalization:

- Proper nouns
- Sentences
- Titles
- Headings
- Subheadings
- Tab titles
- Dialog titles
- Text in dialogs
- Text in alerts
- Text in tooltips
- Text in menus
- Text in buttons
- Text in tabs
- Text in table headers
- Text in table cells
- Text in lists
- Text in sidebars
- Text in labels
- Text in text fields
- Text in text areas
- Text in text boxes
- Text in text editors
- Text in text views

Correct: You can ask Siri to place phone calls, send text messages, send reminders, and more.

Incorrect: You can ask Siri to place phone calls, send text messages, send reminders and more.

communication, communications Use the singular to describe the act of communicating; use the plural to describe the technology.

compact disc See CD.

companion iPhone Don't use. See also pair, paired.

Company, Co. Spell out or abbreviate according to the particular company's preference.

Compass Waypoints The feature name. You can use *Compass Waypoint* or just *waypoint* to refer to an individual waypoint. Don't use *compass waypoint*.

Use Compass Waypoints to mark locations of interest, and then view the elevation of each waypoint relative to your current location.

You can use the Action button to drop a Compass Waypoint.

compile time (n.), compile-time (adj.) Note hyphenation of adjective.

complications It's OK to use *complication* to refer to a feature you can add to the watch face on Apple Watch, as long as you define *complication* on first use. However, in most cases, avoid using any specific term to refer to these features; simply discuss them generically—for example, *you can add an alarm to the watch face*, not *you can add an alarm complication to the watch face*.

component video Note lowercase.

composite video Note lowercase.

comprise The whole *comprises* its parts. This word is misused so often that correct usage might confuse the reader; avoid it altogether. Use *is composed of*, *includes*, *consists of*, *contains*, or another word, as appropriate. Never use *is comprised of*, which in strict usage is equivalent to *is included of*.

computer Use when you describe a computer without any peripherals. Don't use *machine* or *unit*. See also system.

computer voice See code font.

connect Use to refer to the act of joining devices together; don't use *attach*, *hook up*, or *mate*. You *connect* USB devices to a computer, and you can connect computers to a network. Don't use *connect* when you mean *plug in*. See also plug in (v.), plug into (v.).

connector Use to refer only to an item that can be plugged into a receptacle (such as a slot, port, or socket). Use the following terminology:

edge connector: the connector on the edge of a peripheral card; fits into a slot

minicircular connector: an 8-pin connector [Don't use *mini-DIN*.]

plug: a connector with prongs or pins

In user materials, describe connectors by their shape and size, by the icon that appears on the connector, or in another way appropriate to the context. Users should be able to identify the connector easily, even if they don't know the terminology.

Avoid obscure names such as *power input unit* in favor of more direct terms, such as *plug*. Don't use *male* or *female* to describe types of connectors.

See also jack; port; slot; socket; USB connector types.

constitute Parts *constitute* a whole. A whole *comprises* parts. See also comprise.

contacts, Contacts Use lowercase to refer to a user's collection of contacts: *Add a contact, update your contacts*. Capitalize when referring to the app name: *Use Contacts to call someone, get help using Contacts*. See also iCloud.

contextual menu The menu that appears when a user presses the Control key and clicks an item on the screen. In user materials, use *shortcut menu*, not *contextual menu*. However, you can refer to the menu parenthetically as a contextual menu on first reference for users who may be more familiar with that term.

A shortcut menu (also called a *contextual menu*) appears.

See also menus.

contractions As part of Apple's informal voice, contractions are used and recommended throughout most documentation, interface text, and marketing copy. Keep localization in mind when deciding how or whether to use contractions.

- Use common contractions of be–verbs and auxiliary verbs with *not* (*aren't, isn't, can't, couldn't, didn't, doesn't, hadn't, haven't, weren't, won't*).

  You don't have access to the information.

  The error shouldn't occur again.

- Use common contractions of be–verbs and auxiliary verbs with personal pronouns (*he's, I'm, I've, it's, she'll, they're, we've, you're*). It's also OK to use *here's, let's, that's, there's*, and *what's*.

  Here's a quick look at what's new in this release.

  We're building a solar farm in China.

- Don't form contractions from nouns or proper nouns.

  Avoid: The computer's not working.

  Preferable: The computer isn't working.

  Avoid: Apple's going to introduce a new computer today.

  Preferable: Apple is going to introduce a new computer today.

- Avoid contractions of multipart verbs (*could've*), colloquialisms (*workin'*), and other contractions that are uncommon or awkward-sounding in written materials, or that may confuse nonnative English speakers (*everybody'd, how're, it'll, many's, when's, where'll, who've, why'll*). Possible exceptions include text that's meant to be spoken (such as a script) and direct quotes in running text.

- Don't confuse *it's* (the contraction for *it is*) with *its* (a possessive pronoun).

  It's important for the department to keep track of its computers.

See also possessives.

Control Center Don't precede with *the*.

Click an item in Control Center to see additional options.

control character (n.), control-character (adj.) Note hyphenation of adjective.

Control-click (v.) Equivalent to *press the Control key while you click*.

To open a document, Control-click the document icon and choose Open.

See also key, keys.

control key Don't use in a general sense; use *modifier key*. The name of the specific key is capitalized: *Control key*. See also modifier key.

Control key It's OK to abbreviate as *Ctrl* when space constraints don't allow the use of the full term (as in column headings in tables). Don't use *CTRL*.

Control Strip A set of system controls in the Touch Bar. Items are *in* (not *on*) the Control Strip. You *expand* or *collapse* the Control Strip (not *show* or *hide* it).

To change the volume, tap 🔊 in the Control Strip.

See also Touch Bar.

convert to Not *convert into*.

cookies Not *cookie files*. Use to refer to small text files a website may copy to a user's computer to record information about the user or the computer.

To use some websites, you must set your web browser to accept cookies.

coprocessor No hyphen.

copy You copy a file *to* a disk, not *on* a disk or *onto* a disk.

copy-protect (v.), copy-protected (adj., pred. adj.), copy-protection (n.) Hyphenate in all forms.

A copy-protected disk or file can't be copied legally.

The disc is copy-protected.

copyright page All documentation must have a copyright page or copyright notice. A copyright page includes a copyright notice and an Apple trademark list. A copyright notice includes the © symbol, the year the work was first published, the copyright owner (Apple Inc.), and the statement *All rights reserved*. Onscreen documents also require a copyright notice.

- *Finding the correct copyright notice:* The copyright page is a boilerplate element. Consult with your department editor to be sure you have the appropriate boilerplate.

- *Apple trademarks:* All Apple trademarks mentioned in the document must receive a credit line on the copyright page. See the "Apple trademark list.

- *Third-party trademarks:* Certain third-party trademarks also must receive a credit line on the copyright page. See the "Special and Licensed Trademarks and/or Copyrights" section of the Apple trademark list.

See also trademarks (credit lines and symbols); trademarks (usage).

cord Use only to describe a power cord or a phone cord. See also cable.

core Short for *execution core* or *processor core*. See also dual-core (adj.).

Corporation, Corp. Spell out or abbreviate according to the particular corporation's preference.

corrupted Avoid if possible. Use *damaged* instead.

country Avoid using the term *country* when referring to a geographical area. Instead, use *country or region* or just *region*.

Features may vary based on country or region.

Some features are not available in all countries or regions.

cover glass Use to refer to the surface on the front of Apple Vision Pro.

For optimal performance, keep the cover glass clean and smudge-free.

CPU Abbreviation for *central processing unit*. Avoid in user materials; use *processor* to refer to the chip and use *computer* or *system* to refer to the computer itself. For guidelines about spelling out abbreviations, see abbreviations and acronyms. See also computer; processor; system.

CR Abbreviation for *carriage return*. Use only when you refer specifically to ASCII character $0D or its equivalent. Explain the term *carriage return* if your audience includes first-time computer users. For guidelines about spelling out abbreviations, see abbreviations and acronyms.

Use *return character* when you write about, for example, searches for return characters. Use *Return key* for the key users press.

crash Don't use; use *quits unexpectedly, doesn't respond*, or *stops responding*. If you must use this word, put it in quotation marks and reassure the reader that the term *crash* doesn't imply damage to hardware or software.

Crash Detection Note capitalization.

Crash Detection is turned on by default.

creator types Use code font for creator type names, which must consist of exactly four characters (one of which may be a space) inside straight, single, code-font quotation marks.

```
'ttxt','MPS '
```

crosshair Use to refer to this pointer:

cross-references Guidelines for cross-references vary by department, document type, and delivery method. This section provides general guidelines, but always consult your department's style guidelines if in doubt about which style to use, and be consistent within a document.

- *Titles of books and other documents:* In general, use title-style capitalization and italics; don't use quotation marks unless italics aren't available. Don't capitalize or italicize phrases such as *user guide* unless they're part of the title as it appears on the cover page of the document. Don't include trademark symbols.

  See the *iPhone User Guide*.

  For detailed information about using Apple Watch, download the user guide.

  Exception: In onscreen text, it's acceptable to write the titles of user guides (and other books) in roman, with no quotation marks. Titles are often links—which are typically not italicized—so even if a title is not a link, you may want to make it match the style of other linked titles (roman, with no quotation marks).

  For more information about adding contacts, see the Contacts User Guide.

  iMac Essentials provides all the information you need to set up and start using your new iMac.

- *Titles of chapters or sections of a document:* Authoring and output tools typically determine the format of links to chapters or sections within a document. For cross-references that aren't links, match the capitalization style of the chapter or section title, and enclose the title in quotation marks. If you refer to a chapter by number, don't enclose the word *Chapter* or the chapter number in quotation marks.

  For more information, see the "Edit with multicam clips" section of the Final Cut Pro User Guide.

  See Chapter 1, "Ready, Set Up, Go," on page 7.

See also capitalization.

crown See Digital Crown.

Ctrl Abbreviation for *Control*. Use the abbreviation only when space constraints don't allow use of the full term (as in column headings in tables); otherwise, use *Control*, as in *Control key* or *Control-S*. Don't use *CTRL*.

curly brackets Don't use *curly brackets* to describe these symbols: { }; use *braces*.

cursor Don't use in describing the macOS or iOS interface; use *insertion point* or *pointer*, depending on the context. The term *cursor* is appropriate when you describe the VoiceOver interface and may be appropriate when you describe other interfaces and in developer materials. See also insertion point; pointer.

custom installation Not *custom install*. Users *perform a custom installation*; they don't *do a custom install*. See also install; installation; normal installation.

Helpful? Yes No

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